

Streamlining IT Procurement:

Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer

Problem Statement

The existing IT procurement process involves several manual steps, which can lead to delays and inefficiencies, particularly when processing standard laptop requests. Standard laptop orders often require configuration by the hardware team after approval. However, the configuration task may be overlooked or assigned late, resulting in longer user wait times and additional workload for the IT department. An automated workflow is therefore required to ensure that configuration tasks are created and assigned to the appropriate hardware team immediately after the service request is approved.

User Story

As an IT procurement team member, I want an automated workflow for standard laptop requests so that a configuration task is automatically created and assigned to the Hardware team after approval. This ensures that laptops can be configured promptly upon arrival, reducing user waiting time and minimizing manual intervention.

Project Objective

The primary objective of this project is to automate the standard laptop procurement and configuration process using **ServiceNow Flow Designer**.

The project aims to:

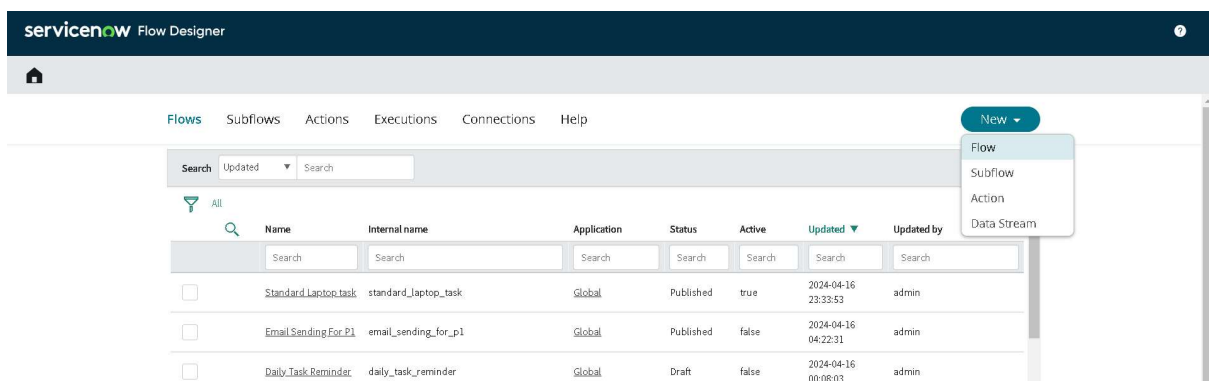
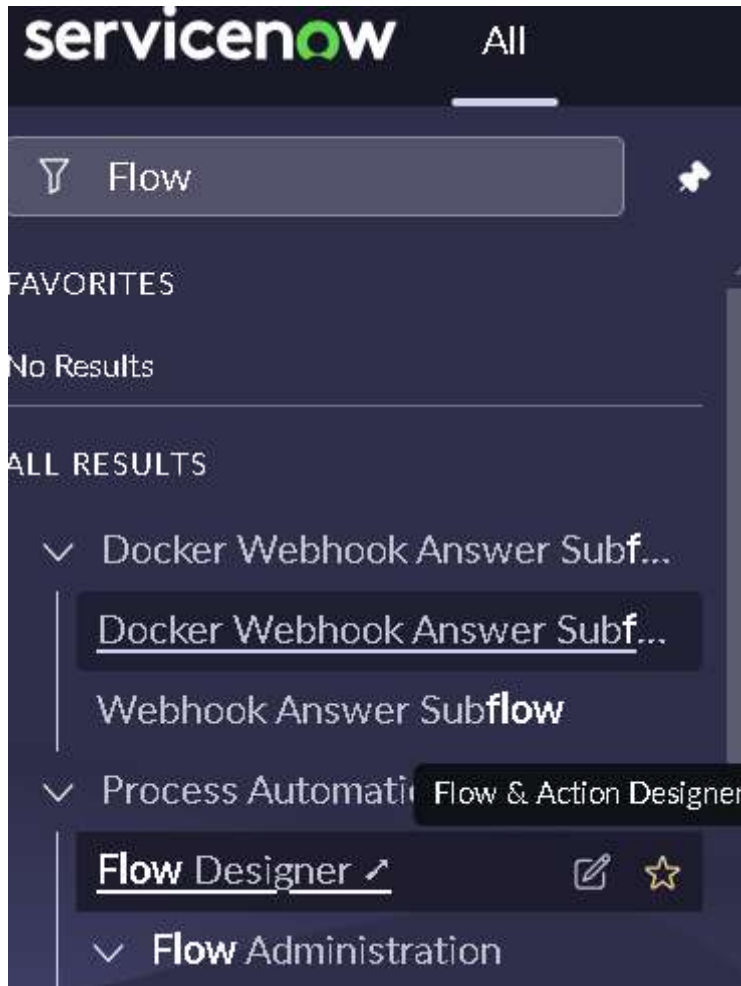
1. Provide a smooth and efficient process for users requesting standard laptops.
 2. Automatically create configuration tasks after the service request is approved.
 3. Automatically assign the configuration task to the Hardware team.
 4. Reduce manual intervention and minimize the possibility of human errors.
 5. Improve task allocation and resource utilization within the IT department.
 6. Reduce laptop delivery and configuration delays.
 7. Improve the overall efficiency and productivity of IT procurement operations.
-

TASK INITIATION

Milestone 1: Create the Flow

Activity 1: Create a Flow to Generate a Catalog Task After Approval

The first milestone involves creating a Flow Designer workflow that automatically creates a Catalog Task once a standard laptop request has been approved. The task is assigned to the Hardware group for configuration.



Flow properties



* Flow name

Description

Application

Protection

Run As

Cancel

Submit



Flow
VPN



Flow
Email sending for P1



Flow
Standard laptop task



Standard laptop task

Inactive

View:



TRIGGER

Abort trigger creation

Trigger

Search triggers

RECORD

Created
Updated
Created or Updated

DATE

Daily

Created

Trigger initiates from a ServiceNow record creation that meets the condition filter.

ACTIONS

Add an Action, Flow

ERROR HANDLER

TRIGGER

Service Catalog

Trigger Service Catalog

Advanced Options

Delete Cancel Done

Steps:

1. Log in to **ServiceNow**.
2. Navigate to **All** and search for **Flow Designer**.
3. Select **Flow Designer** under **Process Automation**.
4. In Flow Designer, click **New** and select **Flow**.
5. Under **Flow Properties**, enter the Flow Name as “**Standard Laptop Task**”.
6. Set the **Application** to **Global**.
7. Select **System User** as the **Run As** option.
8. Click **Submit**.

Configure the Trigger

9. Click **Add a Trigger**.
10. Search for and select the **Service Catalog** trigger.
11. Configure the required trigger conditions and click **Done**.

Configure the Action

12. Navigate to the **Actions** section.
13. Click **Add an Action**.
14. Search for and select **Create Catalog Task**.
15. Configure the action with the following details:
 - **Action:** Create Catalog Task
 - **Request Item:** Select the **Requested Item Record** using the data pill.
 - **Table:** Automatically populated as **Catalog Task**.

- **Short Description:** Laptop needs to be configured
16. Click **Add Field Value**.
 17. Select the **Description** field and enter:
Laptop needs to be configured
 18. Select the **Assignment Group** field and choose **Hardware**.
 19. Set the **Approval** field to **Approved**.
 20. Leave the remaining fields at their default values.
 21. Click **Done**.
 22. Click **Save** to save the Flow.
 23. Click **Activate** and confirm the activation.



Standard Laptop task

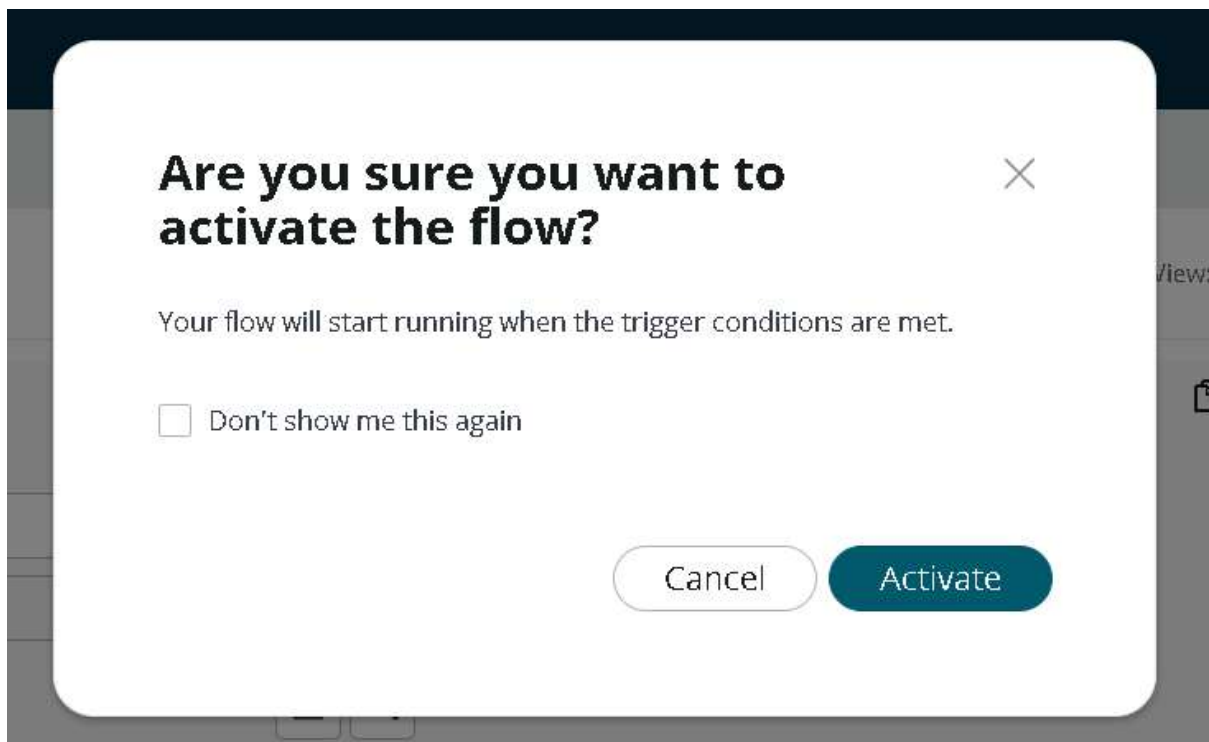
Active

The screenshot shows the ServiceNow interface for a flow named 'Standard Laptop task', which is marked as 'Active'. The 'Action' tab is selected, and a dropdown menu is open, displaying a list of actions. The 'Create Catalog Task' action is highlighted at the top of the list. The list includes the following actions:

- Create Catalog Task (ServiceNow Core)
- Look Up Record (ServiceNow Core)
- Wait For Condition (ServiceNow Core)
- Create Record (ServiceNow Core)
- SLA Percentage Timer (ServiceNow Core)
- Send Email (ServiceNow Core)
- Update Record (ServiceNow Core)
- Create Template (ServiceNow Core)

The left sidebar shows the 'ERROR HANDLING' section with the text 'If an error occurs...'. The top navigation bar includes buttons for 'Action', 'Flow Logic', and 'Subflow'.

Name	Short description	Active	Roles	Catalogs	Category	Price	Type	Updated
Standard Laptop	Lenovo - Carbonx1	true		Service Catalog	Hardware	\$1,100.00	Item	2024-04-16 04:14:53
Standard 27" Monitor	Size - 27", Resolution - 1920x1080, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$0.00	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
Standard 22" Monitor	Full HD, IPS Panel with VGA, HDMI, DVI, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$200.00	Item	2016-03-08 16:49:50
Standard 24" Monitor	TUV-certified Monitor Has Flicker-free S...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$292.28	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33



Milestone 2: Assign the Flow to the Standard Laptop Catalog Item

Activity 1: Configure Flow Assignment

The second milestone involves linking the newly created Flow to the **Standard Laptop** service catalog item.

Steps:

1. Log in to **ServiceNow**.
2. Navigate to **All** and search for **Maintain Items**.
3. Select **Maintain Items**.
4. In the **Name** field, search for **Standard Laptop**.
5. Open the **Standard Laptop** catalog item.
6. Navigate to the **Process Engine** section.
7. Remove any unnecessary existing automation, if applicable.
8. Add the newly created Flow named “**Standard Laptop Task**”.
9. Save the catalog item using the appropriate save option.

Name	Short description	Active	Roles	Catalogs	Category	Price	Type	Updated
Standard Laptop	Lenovo - Carbon x1	true		Service Catalog	Hardware	\$1,100.00	Item	2024-04-16 04:14:53
Standard 27" Monitor	Size - 27", Resolution - 1920x1080, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$0.00	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33
Standard 22" Monitor	Full HD, IPS Panel with VGA, HDMI, DVI, ...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$200.00	Item	2016-03-08 16:49:50
Standard 24" Monitor	TUV-certified Monitor Has Flicker-free S...	true		Service Catalog	Peripherals	\$292.28	Item	2022-11-20 20:46:33

Catalog Item: Standard Laptop

Name: Standard Laptop Application: Global

Catalogs: Service Catalog Active: ☒

Category: Hardware Fulfillment automation level: Unspecified

State: -- None --

Checked out: -- None --

Owner:

Process Engine

Select the appropriate process engine for the catalog item. Only one engine can be selected.

Flow: Standard Laptop task

Workflow:

Execution Plan:

Update Copy Try It Edit in Catalog Builder Delete

Milestone 3: Service Catalog Testing

Activity 1: Place a Standard Laptop Request and Verify Approval

The third milestone is used to test the complete automated workflow by placing a standard laptop request through the Service Catalog.

Steps:

1. Navigate to **All** and search for **Service Catalog**.
2. Open **Service Catalog**.
3. Navigate to **Hardware**.
4. Locate and select **Standard Laptop**.
5. Click **Order Now** to submit the laptop request.
6. After submitting the request, check the **Order Status**.
7. Open the corresponding **Request Number**.
8. Navigate to the **Approvers** section.
9. Open the approval record and approve the request. After approval, navigate to the **Requested Item** section. Open the corresponding **Requested Item** record. Scroll down to the **Catalog Tasks** section. Open the generated Catalog Task. Verify that the task contains the correct:
 - Short description
 - Assignment group
 - Approval status
 - Confirm that the task has been assigned to the **Hardware** group for laptop configuration.

FavoritesHistoryWorkspacesAdmin

Standard Laptop

Search

<Service Catalog > Hardware > Standard Laptop

Search catalog

Lenovo - Carbon x1

x1 Carbon

The x1 Carbon is Lenovo's lightest ThinkPad yet. It provides a QHD display that fights glare and weighs less than three pounds. Ideal for most computing tasks, and highly mobile.

Technical Specs:

- Intel core i5 processor
- 512GB solid state drive (SSD)
- Backlit keyboard

Optional Software

- ☐ Adobe Acrobat
- ☐ Adobe Photoshop

Additional software requirements

Order this Item

Price

₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Quantity

1

Subtotal

₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Delivery

Order Now0 Days

Order Now

Add to Cart

Shopping Cart

Empty

Order Status

Back to CatalogContinue ShoppingHome

Thank you, your request has been submitted

Order Placed: 2024-04-17 04:07:11

Request Number: REQ0010001

Estimated Delivery Date of Complete Order: 2024-04-17

Description (Includes Annual Charges)	Delivery Date	Stage	Price (ea.)	Quantity	Total
Lenovo - Carbon x1	2024-04-17		₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually	1	₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually
Total					₹91,931.2306 + ₹8,357.3846 Annually

Back to CatalogContinue Shopping

Home

FavoritesHistoryWorkspacesAdmin

Request - REQ0010001

Search

<Request REQ0010001

DiscussFollowUpdateAdd New ItemCancel RequestCopyDelete

Short description

Special instructions

UpdateAdd New ItemCancel RequestCopyDelete

Related Links

Show WorkflowWorkflow Context

Requested Items (1)Approvers (1)Recurring Prices (1)

StateSearch

Actions on selected rows...Edit

Approval for = REQ0010001

	State	Approver	Comments	Created
☐	Requested	Eric Schroeder		2024-04-17 04:07:12

1 to 1 of 1

Update
Add New Item
Cancel Request
Copy
Delete

Related Links
[Show Workflow](#)
[Workflow Context](#)

Requested Items (1)
Prices (1)

State

Show Matching
Filter Out
Copy URL to Clipboard
Copy sys_id
Assign Tag
Approve
Reject

Approval for = REQ

State

Approver
Comments
Created

Requested Item
Eric Schroeder

2024-04-17 04:07:12

1 to 1 of 1

Favorites
History
Workspaces
Admin

Requested Item - RITM0010001

Search

Discuss
Follow
Update
Delete

Activities: 1

System Administrator

Impact 3 - Low
Opened by System Administrator
Priority 4 - Low
State Open

Field changes • 2024-04-17 04:07:10

Update
Delete

Related Links
[Flow Context](#)

Catalog Tasks (1)
Approvers
Group approvals

Number

Search

Request item = RITM0010001

Number
Assignment group
Assigned to
Short description
Actual start
Actual end
Order

SCTASK0010001
Hardware
(empty)
Laptop needs to Configured
2024-04-17 04:11:40
(empty)

1 to 1 of 1

Workflow Summary

The overall automated process can be summarized as:

User submits Standard Laptop Request

↓

Service Catalog Request Created

↓

Request Sent for Approval

↓

Request Approved

↓

Flow Designer Triggered



Catalog Task Automatically Created



Task Assigned to Hardware Team



Laptop Configuration Performed



Laptop Ready for User

The screenshot shows a ServiceNow Catalog Task form for the task ID SCTASK0010001. The form is titled "CatalogTask SCTASK0010001" and includes a header with navigation buttons: Discuss, Follow, Update, Close Task, and Delete. The form is divided into several sections:

- Metadata:** Number (SCTASK0010001), Approval (Approved), Priority (4 - Low), State (Open), Request item (RITM0010001), and Requested for (System Administrator).
- Assignment:** Assigned to (empty field with search icon) and Configuration item (empty field with search icon).
- Active:** A checkbox labeled "Active" is checked.
- Description:** Short description (Laptop needs to Configured) and Description (Laptop needs to Configured).
- Worknotes:** A text area labeled "Worknotes" with the text "Worknotes" and a "Post" button.
- Activities:** A section at the bottom labeled "Activities: 1" with a search icon.

Conclusion

The automation of the standard laptop procurement process using **ServiceNow Flow Designer** provides a structured and efficient approach to managing laptop requests. Once a request is approved, the workflow automatically creates a Catalog Task and assigns it to the Hardware team for configuration.

This reduces manual intervention, minimizes the possibility of missed or delayed configuration tasks, and improves coordination between the procurement and hardware

teams. As a result, the process can reduce user waiting time, improve resource utilization, and increase the overall efficiency of IT procurement operations.

The implemented workflow demonstrates how ServiceNow automation can be used to transform a manual procurement process into a more consistent, traceable, and efficient service delivery process.